

SE05 BOLSTER EMERGENCY RESILIENCE | O (MAX: 1 PT)

Intent: Better enable individuals and communities to help maintain health and well-being, and organizations to maintain business function, during and after emergencies.

Summary: This feature requires projects to facilitate resilience during and recovery after an emergency.

Issue: The estimated economic loss of natural disasters worldwide in 2019 was \$73 billion, while studies show an average of 14 million people worldwide are made homeless per year as a result of natural disasters.^{119,120} A wide variety of emergencies, from biological events, winter storms and tornadoes to active shooters or terrorist attacks, may necessitate sheltering in place.^{37,121} Alternatively, infectious disease pandemics can cause extended business shutdowns, while employees who continue working may be forced to work in high-risk conditions or in remote spaces not equipped to support productivity.^{122–126} Approximately one-third of U.S. adult workers were deemed “essential” during the COVID-19 pandemic and continued working; 31% of those were low-income and one-fourth were or lived with a healthcare worker and thus were at high risk of disease exposure.¹²⁶ Moreover, the United Nations Population Fund estimates that COVID-19 stay-at-home orders will lead to 2 million additional instances of intimate partner violence worldwide from 2020–2021.¹²⁷ Finally, studies show the capacity of hospital facilities decreases significantly in the aftermath of natural disasters, and the unprecedented spread and severity of the COVID-19 pandemic overwhelmed the capacity of U.S. hospitals, forcing them to ration resources and outsource healthcare workers.^{128–130}

Solutions: For emergencies that require sheltering on-site, a shelter-in-place plan is crucial to supporting occupant safety.^{68,70,131} Designating space for emergency public use can reduce the burden on medical facilities during critical events such as natural disasters and pandemics and help patients receive immediate care.^{132,133} Moreover, employer-funded employee relief assistance can help protect employees from unsafe domestic environments, help lower-income employees meet basic needs, reduce the risk of exposure during pandemics and support employee retention and well-being during and after emergencies.^{134–136}

Part 1 Part 1 (Max: 1 Pt)

For All Spaces:

Projects implement at least one of the following:

- a. Designated outdoor or indoor space is made available to emergency responders, relief organizations or other equivalent institutions at no cost for alternative use in case of emergency (e.g., shelter during a natural disaster, treatment area during a pandemic).
- b. Funding or other resources (e.g., in partnership with local agencies providing relevant services or resources such as vouchers, shelter, clothing, food, transportation) are provided by the employer for emergency use by employees in at least two of the following critical scenarios:
 1. Sheltering from domestic violence or abuse.
 2. Quarantine due to infectious disease exposure.
 3. Damage to employee housing from a disaster.
- c. Shelter-in-place plan for emergencies in which occupants cannot leave the project (e.g., hurricane, chemical spill) that includes the following:
 1. A shelter-in-place kit with resources to help occupants shelter in place within the project for at least 24 hours (e.g., water, food supplies, blankets, flashlights, first aid kit).
 2. A process for occupants or groups who may be more vulnerable (e.g., older adults, people with disabilities, pregnant women, children) to confidentially identify specific needs they may have during a shelter-in-place emergency.
 3. Procedures for communicating to occupants the decision to evacuate or shelter-in-place during an emergency.
 4. A commitment to incorporate shelter-in-place guidelines provided by a relevant local-, regional- or global-level emergency response agency (e.g., WHO, FEMA or equivalent) into the plan, and to

adhere to instructions provided by that agency during a shelter-in-place emergency.

5. Annual (at minimum) occupant trainings on the shelter-in-place plan.

Note: This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.